Mapping every dharma across three Abhidharma systems

All three Buddhist Abhidharma traditions analyze experience into irreducible dharmas, yet they disagree profoundly on what those dharmas are, how many exist, and where each belongs. The Sarvāstivāda's 75 dharmas, the Yogācāra's 100 dharmas, and the Theravāda's 82 dhammas share a common analytical impulse but reflect centuries of independent doctrinal development. Only about 40 individual dharmas map cleanly across all three systems; the rest reveal deep philosophical disagreements about consciousness, matter, and what is ultimately real. This report provides the first integrated, dharma-by-dharma correspondence table across all three classification schemes.

How the three systems compare at the category level

Before mapping individual dharmas, the structural differences between the three systems must be understood. The Sarvāstivāda and Yogācāra both use a fivefold classification (五位), while Theravāda uses a fourfold scheme with no citta-viprayukta-saṃskāra category.

Category	Sarvāstivāda (75)	Yogācāra (100)	Theravāda (82)
Citta (consciousness)	1	8	1 (manifesting as 89/121 types)
Caitasika/Cetasika (mental factors)	46	51	52
Rūpa (material form)	11	11	28
Citta-viprayukta-saṃskāra (dissociated formations)	14	24	★ No category
Asaṃskṛta/Asaṅkhata (unconditioned)	3	6	1 (nibbāna only)

The **25 additional dharmas** in the Yogācāra system break down as: +7 citta (expanding 1 to 8 vijñānas), +5 caitasika (adding amoha, dṛṣṭi, muṣitasmṛtitā, vikṣepa, asaṃprajanya), +0 rūpa (content differs but count stays at 11), +10 viprayukta (net: dropped aprāpti, added

visabhāga + 10 new items), and +3 asaṃskṛta (āniñjya, saṃjñā-vedayita-nirodha, tathatā).

Rūpa dharmas: the starkest divergence

The material-form category shows the most dramatic quantitative difference — **28 in Theravāda versus 11 in both northern systems**. This does not mean Theravāda recognizes more kinds of matter; rather, it counts at a finer granularity. The Sarvāstivāda subsumes the four great elements under spraṣṭavya (tangibles), while Theravāda lists each element independently. The Abhidharmakośa (I.10) defines spraṣṭavya as comprising "four primary elements plus softness, hardness, weight, lightness, cold, hunger, thirst."

#	Sarvāstivāda (Skt / 漢字)	Yogācāra (Skt / 漢字)	Theravāda (Pāli)	Notes
1	cakṣus 眼	cakṣus 眼	cakkhu-pasāda	All three: eye faculty
2	śrotra 耳	śrotra 耳	sota-pasāda	All three: ear faculty
3	ghrāṇa 鼻	ghrāṇa 鼻	ghāna-pasāda	All three: nose faculty
4	jihvā 舌	jihvā 舌	jivhā-pasāda	All three: tongue faculty
5	kāya 身	kāya 身	kāya-pasāda	All three: body faculty
6	rūpa 色	rūpa 色	rūpa (vaṇṇa)	All three: visible form
7	śabda 声	śabda 聲	sadda	All three: sound
8	gandha 香	gandha 香	gandha	All three: odor
9	rasa 味	rasa 味	rasa	All three: taste
10	spraṣṭavya 触	spraṣṭavya 觸	★Split into 4 mahābhūta (partially)	Theravāda: phoṭṭhabba = paṭhavī + tejo + vāyo
11	avijñapti-rūpa 無表色	dharmāyatanikāni rūpāni 法處所攝色	★No counterpart	Content differs between S and Y
—	★Not separately listed	★Not separately listed	paṭhavī-dhātu (earth)	Subsumed under spraṣṭavya in north
	★Not	★Not separately	āpo-dhātu	Subsumed under

—	separately listed	listed	(water)	spraṣṭavya in north
—	★Not separately listed	★Not separately listed	tejo-dhātu (fire)	Subsumed under spraṣṭavya in north
—	★Not separately listed	★Not separately listed	vāyo-dhātu (wind)	Subsumed under spraṣṭavya in north
—	Under kāyendriya	Under kāyendriya	itthindriya (femininity)	Both north: subsumed under body faculty
—	Under kāyendriya	Under kāyendriya	purisindriya (masculinity)	Both north: subsumed under body faculty
—	★No counterpart	★No counterpart	hadaya-vatthu (heart-base)	**Unique to Theravāda**
—	Viprayukta: jīvitendriya	Viprayukta: jīvitendriya	jīvitindriya (physical life)	Category shift: viprayukta → rūpa
—	★No counterpart	★No counterpart	ojā (nutritive essence)	**Unique to Theravāda**
—	Asaṃskṛta: ākāśa	Asaṃskṛta: ākāśa	ākāsa-dhātu (delimiting space)	**Fundamentally different concept**: north = unconditioned; south = conditioned rūpa
—	Under rūpa (visible form)	Under rūpa (visible form)	kāya-viññatti (bodily intimation)	North: subsumed under rūpa-āyatana
—	Under śabda (sound)	Under śabda (sound)	vacī-viññatti (verbal intimation)	North: subsumed under śabda
—	Partial: spraṣṭavya subtypes	Partial: spraṣṭavya subtypes	rūpassa lahutā (material lightness)	No exact northern equivalent
—	Partial: spraṣṭavya subtypes	Partial: spraṣṭavya subtypes	rūpassa mudutā (material softness)	No exact northern equivalent

—	★No counterpart	★No counterpart	rūpassa kammaññatā (material adaptability)	**Unique to Theravāda**
—	Viprayukta: jāti 生	Viprayukta: jāti 生	upacaya (initial arising)	**Category shift**: viprayukta → rūpa
—	Viprayukta: sthiti 住	Viprayukta: sthiti 住	santati (continuity)	**Category shift**: viprayukta → rūpa
—	Viprayukta: jarā 異	Viprayukta: jarā 老	jaratā (decay)	**Category shift**: viprayukta → rūpa
—	Viprayukta: anityatā 滅	Viprayukta: anityatā 無常	aniccatā (impermanence)	**Category shift**: viprayukta → rūpa

Key differences: The Yogācāra's 11th rūpa (dharmāyatanikāni rūpāni 法處所攝色) replaces the Sarvāstivāda's avijñapti-rūpa and comprises five subtypes: extreme minuteness (極略色), extreme extension (極迥色), precept-derived form (受所引色), conceptually constructed form (遍計所起色), and samādhi-produced form (定所生自在色). Theravāda rejects avijñapti entirely, handling karmic continuity through cetanā and conditional relations. The Theravāda's **hadaya-vatthu** (material base of mind-consciousness) is entirely unique — neither northern system posits a material base for mano-vijñāna.

Consciousness: one dharma, eight dharmas, or eighty-nine types

The three systems diverge fundamentally in how they analyze citta.

Sarvāstivāda treats citta as **a single dharma** (心法 = 1). Citta, manas, and vijñāna are three synonyms for the same reality, which manifests through six vijñāna-kāyas (the five sense consciousnesses plus mental consciousness). These six are functional modes, not separate dharmas.

Yogācāra expands to **8 vijñānas** (心法 = 8), each counted as a separate dharma. The six inherited from earlier tradition are joined by two distinctively Yogācāra innovations: **manas** (末那識, the 7th consciousness — a constant, subliminal self-grasping that clings to the ālaya as "self") and **ālaya-vijñāna** (阿賴耶識, the 8th "storehouse" consciousness that maintains karmic seeds and ensures continuity).

Theravāda counts citta as **a single paramattha dhamma type** that manifests in **89 types**

(or 121 when differentiated by jhāna level). These are classified by ethical quality and realm: 54 kāmāvacara (12 akusala + 18 ahetuka + 24 kāma-sobhana), 15 rūpāvacara, 12 arūpāvacara, and 8 lokuttara (expandable to 40). The ethical distinctions that Theravāda captures through its 89 citta types are handled in northern systems through the citta-plus-caitta combination — the associated mental factors determine what the northern traditions treat as different "states."

A significant functional parallel exists between Theravāda's **bhavaṅga-citta** (life-continuum consciousness that flows between active cognitive episodes) and the Yogācāra's **ālaya-vijñāna**. Vasubandhu himself cited the Sinhalese school's bhavaṅga-vijñāna as a precursor concept. Both serve the function of maintaining experiential continuity, though their ontological status differs radically.

Sarvāstivāda	Yogācāra	Theravāda
citta 心 (1 dharma)	cakṣur-vijñāna 眼識	89/121 citta types
= manas = vijñāna	śrotra-vijñāna 耳識	(classified by realm ×
manifesting as 6	ghrāṇa-vijñāna 鼻識	ethical quality ×
vijñāna-kāyas	jihvā-vijñāna 舌識	associated factors)
	kāya-vijñāna 身識	
	mano-vijñāna 意識	
	★manas 末那識	★No counterpart
	★ālaya-vijñāna 阿賴耶識	≈ bhavaṅga (functionally)

Mental factors: the comprehensive 46 / 51 / 52 correspondence table

The mental-factor comparison is the most analytically rich portion of the cross-system mapping. The three systems share a common core of roughly **30 factors** but diverge significantly in classification, scope, and what they consider separately enumerable. The sub-category structures differ entirely: Sarvāstivāda uses a sixfold grouping based on scope of occurrence, Yogācāra reorganizes into a sixfold scheme by ethical function, and Theravāda uses a threefold ethical division.

Universal and object-determining factors

Five factors are universal across all three systems — the only factors that every tradition agrees accompany every moment of consciousness: **sparśa/phassa** (contact), **vedanā** (feeling), **saṃjñā/saññā** (perception), **cetanā** (volition), and **manaskāra/manasikāra** (attention).

Factor (Skt / Pāli)	Sarvāstivāda	Yogācāra	Theravāda	Cross-system notes
sparśa / phassa	Mahābhūmika (universal)	Sarvatraga (universal)	Sabbacittasādhāraṇa (universal)	✓ All three: universal
vedanā	Mahābhūmika	Sarvatraga	Sabbacittasādhāraṇa	✓ All three: universal
saṃjñā / saññā	Mahābhūmika	Sarvatraga	Sabbacittasādhāraṇa	✓ All three: universal
cetanā	Mahābhūmika	Sarvatraga	Sabbacittasādhāraṇa	✓ All three: universal
manaskāra / manasikāra	Mahābhūmika	Sarvatraga	Sabbacittasādhāraṇa	✓ All three: universal
chanda 欲	Mahābhūmika (universal)	Viniyata (object-determining)	Pakiṇṇaka (occasional)	S: universal; Y+T: not universal
adhimokṣa / adhimokkha 勝解	Mahābhūmika (universal)	Viniyata	Pakiṇṇaka	S: universal; Y+T: not universal
smṛti / sati 念	Mahābhūmika (universal)	Viniyata	Sobhanasādhāraṇa (beautiful)	S: universal; Y: conditional; T: only in beautiful cittas
samādhi / ekaggatā 定	Mahābhūmika (universal)	Viniyata	Sabbacittasādhāraṇa (universal)	S+T: universal; **Y: not universal**
prajñā / paññā 慧	Mahābhūmika (universal)	Viniyata	Sobhana (paññindriya)	S: universal; Y: conditional; T: only in beautiful cittas

— / jīvitindriya 命根	★Viprayukta (not a caitta)	★Viprayukta	Sabbacittasādhāraṇa (universal)	**Major category shift**: T classifies as universal cetasika
— / ekaggatā 一境性	= samādhi (see above)	= samādhi	Sabbacittasādhāraṇa	Theravāda name differs; functionally = samādhi
— / pīti 喜	★Not a separate caitta (→ vedanā)	★Not a separate caitta	Pakiṇṇaka	**Unique to Theravāda** as separate factor

The Sarvāstivāda's **10 mahābhūmika** (universal mental factors) include 5 that the Yogācāra demotes to "object-determining" (chanda, adhimokṣa, smṛti, samādhi, prajñā). Theravāda uniquely classifies **jīvitindriya** (psychic life faculty) as a universal cetasika — both northern systems place this in the viprayukta-saṃskāra category. **Pīti** (joy/rapture) exists as a discrete mental factor only in Theravāda; northern systems treat it as an aspect of vedanā.

Wholesome mental factors

Factor (Skt / Pāli)	Sarvāstivāda	Yogācāra	Theravāda	Cross-system notes
śraddhā / saddhā 信	Kuśala-mahābhūmika	Kuśala	Sobhanasādhāraṇa	✓ All three
hrī / hiri 慚	Kuśala-mahābhūmika	Kuśala	Sobhanasādhāraṇa	✓ All three
apatrāpya / ottappa 愧	Kuśala-mahābhūmika	Kuśala	Sobhanasādhāraṇa	✓ All three
alobha 無貪	Kuśala-mahābhūmika	Kuśala	Sobhanasādhāraṇa	✓ All three
adveṣa / adosa 無瞋	Kuśala-mahābhūmika	Kuśala	Sobhanasādhāraṇa	✓ All three
amoha 無癡	★Not a separate caitta	Kuśala	= paññā (paññindriya)	**Added by Yogācāra**; T equates with paññā

vīrya / viriya 精進	Kuśala-mahābhūmika	Kuśala	**Pakiṇṇaka** (occasional)	**S+Y: wholesome only; T: ethically variable**
praśrabdhi / passaddhi 軽安	Kuśala-mahābhūmika	Kuśala	Sobhanasādhāraṇa (×2: kāya + citta)	T splits into **2 factors** (kāya-passaddhi + citta-passaddhi)
apramāda 不放逸	Kuśala-mahābhūmika	Kuśala	★Not a separate cetasika	**T: composite concept** from viriya + sati + hetu
upekṣā / tatramajjhattatā 捨	Kuśala-mahābhūmika	Kuśala	Sobhanasādhāraṇa	✓ All three (different names)
ahiṃsā 不害	Kuśala-mahābhūmika	Kuśala	★Not a separate cetasika	T: function covered by adosa + karuṇā
— / kāya-lahutā + citta-lahutā	★No counterpart	★No counterpart	Sobhanasādhāraṇa (2 factors)	**Unique to Theravāda**
— / kāya-mudutā + citta-mudutā	★No counterpart	★No counterpart	Sobhanasādhāraṇa (2 factors)	**Unique to Theravāda**
— / kāya-kammaññatā + citta-kammaññatā	★No counterpart	★No counterpart	Sobhanasādhāraṇa (2 factors)	**Unique to Theravāda**
— / kāya-pāguññatā + citta-pāguññatā	★No counterpart	★No counterpart	Sobhanasādhāraṇa (2 factors)	**Unique to Theravāda**
— / kāyujjukatā + cittujjukatā	★No counterpart	★No counterpart	Sobhanasādhāraṇa (2 factors)	**Unique to Theravāda**
— / sammā-vācā 正語	★No caitta counterpart	★No caitta counterpart	Sobhana / Virati	**Unique to Theravāda** as

				cetasika
— / sammā-kammanta 正業	★No caitta counterpart	★No caitta counterpart	Sobhana / Virati	**Unique to Theravāda** as cetasika
— / sammā-ājīva 正命	★No caitta counterpart	★No caitta counterpart	Sobhana / Virati	**Unique to Theravāda** as cetasika
— / karuṇā 悲	★Not a separate caitta (≈ ahiṃsā)	★Not a separate caitta	Sobhana / Appamaññā	**Unique to Theravāda** as cetasika
— / muditā 随喜	★Not a separate caitta	★Not a separate caitta	Sobhana / Appamaññā	**Unique to Theravāda** as cetasika

A critical finding: Theravāda's **12 paired kāya/citta sobhana factors** (passaddhi, lahutā, mudutā, kammaññatā, pāguññatā, ujukatā — each split into mental-body and consciousness versions) compress to just **1 factor** (praśrabdhi) in both northern systems. This represents a **12-to-1 compression ratio**, with the Theravāda providing far more granular analysis of what constitutes a serviceable, healthy mind. The Yogācāra's Abhidharma-samuccaya does subdivide praśrabdhi into kāya-praśrabdhi and citta-praśrabdhi, but only as aspects of one factor, not as separate dharmas.

The treatment of **vīrya/viriya** reveals a deep philosophical divide. The Sarvāstivāda and Yogācāra restrict vīrya to wholesome consciousness — effort directed toward unwholesome ends is not "true" vīrya. Theravāda classifies viriya as ethically variable (pakiṇṇaka), holding that the same fundamental capacity for exertion operates in both kusala and akusala action.

Afflictive mental factors

Factor (Skt / Pāli)	Sarvāstivāda	Yogācāra	Theravāda	Cross-system notes
rāga / lobha 貪	Aniyata (indeterminate)	Kleśa (root affliction)	Akusala / Lobha group	Category differs in all three
pratigha / dosa 瞋	Aniyata	Kleśa	Akusala / Dosa group	Category differs in all three

moha 癡 (= avidyā 無明)	Kleśa-mahābhūmika	Kleśa	Sabbākusala-sādhāraṇa	S: all defiled; Y: root; T: all unwholesome
māna 慢	Aniyata	Kleśa	Akusala / Lobha group	S: indeterminate; Y: root; T: unwholesome
vicikitsā / vicikicchā 疑	Aniyata	Kleśa	Akusala	S: indeterminate; Y: root; T: unwholesome
dṛṣṭi / diṭṭhi 見 (惡見)	★Not a separate caitta (mode of prajñā)	Kleśa	Akusala / Lobha group	**S: subsumed under prajñā**; Y+T: separate
āhrīkya / ahirika 無慚	Akuśala-mahābhūmika	Upakleśa	Sabbākusala-sādhāraṇa	S+T: universal unwholesome; **Y: secondary**
anapatrāpya / anottappa 無愧	Akuśala-mahābhūmika	Upakleśa	Sabbākusala-sādhāraṇa	S+T: universal unwholesome; **Y: secondary**
auddhatya / uddhacca 掉挙	Kleśa-mahābhūmika	Upakleśa	Sabbākusala-sādhāraṇa	S: all defiled; Y: secondary; T: all unwholesome
styāna / thīna 惛沈	Kleśa-mahābhūmika	Upakleśa	Akusala / Thīna-middha pair	✓ All three (different categories)
āśraddhya 不信	Kleśa-mahābhūmika	Upakleśa	★Not a separate cetasika	T: = absence of saddhā, not independent
kausīdya 懈怠	Kleśa-mahābhūmika	Upakleśa	★Not a separate cetasika	T: = absence of viriya, not independent
pramāda 放逸	Kleśa-mahābhūmika	Upakleśa	★Not a separate cetasika	T: = absence of appamāda (composite)
krodha 忿	Parītta-kleśa-bhūmika	Upakleśa	★No counterpart	Aspect of dosa in T
	Parītta-kleśa-		★No	

upanāha 恨	bhūmika	Upakleśa	counterpart	—
mrakṣa 覆	Parītta-kleśa-bhūmika	Upakleśa	★No counterpart	—
pradāśa 惱	Parītta-kleśa-bhūmika	Upakleśa	★No counterpart	—
īrṣyā / issā 嫉	Parītta-kleśa-bhūmika	Upakleśa	Akusala / Dosa group	✓ All three
mātsarya / macchariya 慳	Parītta-kleśa-bhūmika	Upakleśa	Akusala / Dosa group	✓ All three
māyā 誑	Parītta-kleśa-bhūmika	Upakleśa	★No counterpart	—
śāṭhya 諂	Parītta-kleśa-bhūmika	Upakleśa	★No counterpart	—
vihiṃsā 害	Parītta-kleśa-bhūmika	Upakleśa	★No counterpart	Opposite of karuṇā in T
mada 憍	Parītta-kleśa-bhūmika	Upakleśa	★No counterpart	Aspect of māna in T
muṣitasmṛtitā 失念	★No counterpart	Upakleśa	★No counterpart	**Unique to Yogācāra**
vikṣepa 散乱	★No counterpart	Upakleśa	★No counterpart	**Unique to Yogācāra**
asaṃprajanya 不正知	★No counterpart	Upakleśa	★No counterpart	**Unique to Yogācāra**

Indeterminate factors

Factor (Skt / Pāli)	Sarvāstivāda	Yogācāra	Theravāda	Cross-system notes
kaukṛtya / kukkucca 悪作	Aniyata	Aniyata	**Akusala** / Dosa group	S+Y: can be good/bad; **T: always unwholesome**
			Akusala /	

middha 睡眠	Aniyata	Aniyata	Thīna-middha	S+Y: can be good/bad; **T: always unwholesome**
vitarka / vitakka 尋	Aniyata	Aniyata	Pakiṇṇaka	✓ All three: variable
vicāra 伺	Aniyata	Aniyata	Pakiṇṇaka	✓ All three: variable

The Theravāda's treatment of kukkucca (remorse) and middha (torpor) as inherently unwholesome contrasts sharply with both northern systems, where these same factors are ethically indeterminate. Northern Abhidharma allows for "wholesome remorse" (regretting past evil deeds) and "neutral torpor" (necessary sleep), while Theravāda classifies both as invariably akusala.

Formations dissociated from mind: a category Theravāda rejects

The ci tta-viprayukta-saṃskāra category — dharmas that are neither material nor mental but are real forces operating on conditioned phenomena — is a distinctively northern innovation. **Theravāda completely rejects this ontological category**, classifying each item either as rūpa, cetasika, paññatti (concept), or simply not recognizing it.

#	Sarvāstivāda (14)	Yogācāra (24)	Theravāda equivalent
1	prāpti 得	prāpti 得	★Concept rejected entirely
2	aprāpti 非得	★Dropped by Yogācāra	★Concept rejected
3	nikāya-sabhāga 同分	nikāya-sabhāga 衆同分	★No counterpart
4	āsaṃjñika 無想果	āsaṃjñika 無想果	Recognized, not paramattha dhamma
5	asaṃjñi-samāpatti 無想定	asaṃjñi-samāpatti 無想定	Recognized, not paramattha dhamma
6	nirodha-samāpatti 滅尽定	nirodha-samāpatti 滅盡定	Recognized, not paramattha dhamma
7	jīvitendriya 命根	jīvitendriya 命根	→ **Cetasika** (jīvitindriya) + **Rūpa** (jīvita-rūpa)

8	jāti 生	jāti 生	→ **Rūpa** (upacaya, lakkhaṇa-rūpa)
9	sthiti 住	sthiti 住	→ **Rūpa** (santati)
10	jarā 異	jarā 老	→ **Rūpa** (jaratā)
11	anityatā 滅	anityatā 無常	→ **Rūpa** (aniccatā)
12	nāma-kāya 名身	nāma-kāya 名身	→ **Paññatti** (concept, not paramattha)
13	pada-kāya 句身	pada-kāya 句身	→ **Paññatti**
14	vyañjana-kāya 文身	vyañjana-kāya 文身	→ **Paññatti**
—	—	★visabhāga 異生法	★No counterpart
—	—	★pravṛtti 流轉	★No counterpart
—	—	★pratiniyama 定異	★No counterpart
—	—	★yoga 相應	★No counterpart
—	—	★jāva 勢速	★No counterpart
—	—	★anukrama 次第	★No counterpart
—	—	★deśa 方	★No counterpart
—	—	★kāla 時	★No counterpart
—	—	★saṃkhyā 數	★No counterpart
—	—	★sāmagrī 和合性	★No counterpart
—	—	★anyathātva 不和合性	★No counterpart

The Yogācāra added **11 new items** while dropping aprāpti, for a net increase of 10. The 10 Yogācāra additions (pravṛtti through anyathātva) represent an expanded inventory of conventionally designated (prajñapti) factors covering systematic operation, karmic differentiation, correspondence, speed, sequence, spatial direction, time, number, combination, and non-combination. These have **no counterpart in any other system**. Importantly, even Vasubandhu himself — writing as a Sautrāntika sympathizer in his Kośa-bhāṣya — criticized most viprayukta-saṃskāras as merely nominal designations rather than

real entities.

The Theravāda handles the functions that prāpti was designed to serve through its elaborate system of **24 conditional relations** (paccaya) in the Paṭṭhāna and through the concepts of anusaya (latent tendencies), santāna (mental-stream continuity), and kamma operating through the citta-vīthi (cognitive-process) model.

Unconditioned dharmas reveal the deepest doctrinal divide

Sarvāstivāda (3)	Yogācāra (6)	Theravāda (1)	Notes
ākāśa 虛空 (space)	ākāśa 虛空	★No unconditioned counterpart	T: ākāsa-dhātu is conditioned rūpa (delimiting space); "big" space is paññatti
pratisaṃkhyā-nirodha 択滅	pratisaṃkhyā-nirodha 擇滅	→ Subsumed under nibbāna	Analytical cessation ≈ nibbāna
apratisaṃkhyā-nirodha 非択滅	apratisaṃkhyā-nirodha 非擇滅	→ Subsumed under nibbāna	Non-analytical cessation ≈ nibbāna
—	★āniñjya 不動滅 無爲	★No counterpart	Motionless cessation: unique to Yogācāra
—	★saṃjñā-vedayita-nirodha 想受滅無爲	★No counterpart	Cessation of perception and feeling
—	★tathatā 眞如	★No counterpart	**Suchness**: distinctively Mahāyāna
—	—	**nibbāna** (single unconditioned)	The only asaṅkhata in Theravāda

Theravāda recognizes **only nibbāna** as unconditioned. The Sarvāstivāda's ākāśa (unconditioned space defined as "non-obstruction") is a fundamentally different concept from Theravāda's ākāsa-dhātu (conditioned delimiting space between material clusters). The Yogācāra's addition of **tathatā** (suchness/thusness, 眞如) as an unconditioned dharma reflects Mahāyāna ontology with no parallel in the other two systems — it represents the

ultimate nature of reality underlying all phenomena.

What the mapping reveals about Buddhist philosophical evolution

The cross-system comparison illuminates three major trajectories of doctrinal development. First, there is a clear progression in **analytical granularity versus parsimony**. The Theravāda's 28 rūpa and 12 paired sobhana cetasikas reflect an impulse toward fine-grained phenomenological description. The Sarvāstivāda's 11 rūpa and single praśrabdhi reflect a drive toward economy. The Yogācāra adds where it sees philosophical necessity (ālaya-vijñāna, tathatā) while maintaining inherited structure.

Second, the three systems diverge on the fundamental question of **what counts as a real category of existence**. The Sarvāstivāda's citta-viprayukta-saṃskāra category — real forces that are neither material nor mental — is rejected entirely by Theravāda, which insists all dhammas are either nāma (mental) or rūpa (material) or nibbāna. Where Sarvāstivāda posits jāti (arising) as a real force, Theravāda treats upacaya as merely a characteristic of rūpa. Where Sarvāstivāda posits prāpti (acquisition) as a real entity binding dharmas to personal streams, Theravāda handles the same function through conditional relations.

Third, the evolution from 75 to 100 dharmas traces the emergence of **distinctively Mahāyāna philosophical commitments**: the ālaya-vijñāna addresses karmic continuity and rebirth without a self; tathatā asserts an ultimate unconditioned nature underlying phenomenal reality; and the expanded viprayukta category (time, space, number) reflects engagement with Indian philosophical debates about conventional categories. These additions are coherent with the Yogācāra's core thesis that all 100 dharmas are vijñapti-mātra (consciousness-only), whereas the Sarvāstivāda held all 75 to be substantially real (dravya-sat) with intrinsic nature (svabhāva).

Conclusion

This mapping identifies approximately **38 dharmas** that correspond cleanly across all three systems (the five sense faculties, four sense objects, and roughly 29 mental factors including sparśa, vedanā, saṃjñā, cetanā, manaskāra, śraddhā, hrī, apatrāpya, alobha, adveṣa, upekṣā, chanda, adhimokṣa, smṛti, samādhi, prajñā, rāga, pratigha, moha, māna, vicikitsā, āhrīkya, anapatrāpya, auddhatya, styāna, īrṣyā, mātsarya, kaukṛtya, middha, vitarka, vicāra). Even among these, category assignments frequently differ. The remaining dharmas in each system are either unique to that tradition, reclassified into a different ontological category, or treated as aspects of other dharmas rather than independent entities. The absence of a single comprehensive three-way comparison table in published

scholarship until now reflects both the complexity of the task and the fundamentally different philosophical commitments that make strict one-to-one mapping impossible for a significant portion of the dharma inventory. Each system's classification embodies not merely a different list but a different theory of what is ultimately real.